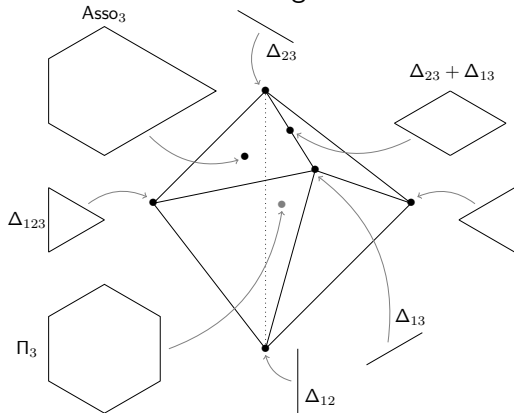


# Deformed permutahedra

## An inductive construction of the submodular cone

**Germain Poullot** with Georg Loho & Arnau Padrol



## 1 Deformations (a.k.a. Minkowski summands)

- Deformations
- Cone of deformations

## 2 Deformed permutahedra = submodularity

- Combinatorics of the permutahedron
- Submodular functions

## 3 Submodular Cone in general

- Known facts about  $\mathbb{SC}_n$
- Submodular cone  $n = 4$  (and  $n = 5$ )

## 4 Inductive construction of (rays of) $\mathbb{SC}_n$

- GP-sum
- Rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$

# *Deformations (a.k.a. Minkowski summands)*

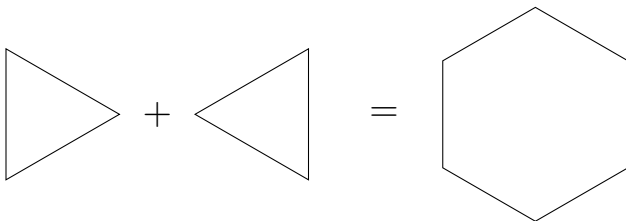
# Minkowski sum

## Definition

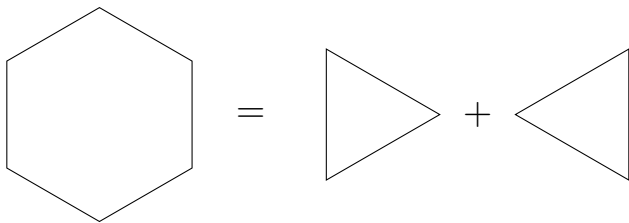
$P, Q$  polytopes. *Minkowski sum*:

$$P + Q = \{ \mathbf{p} + \mathbf{q} \ ; \ \mathbf{p} \in P, \ \mathbf{q} \in Q \}$$

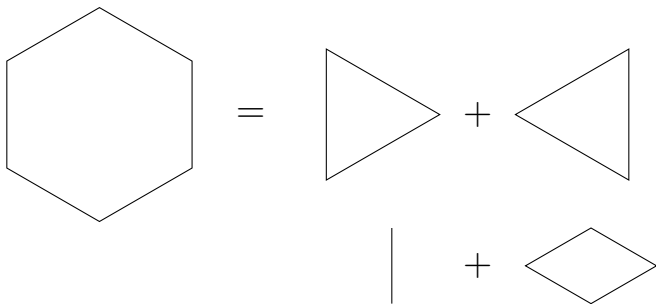
**N.B.**  $\text{Vert}(P + Q) \subseteq \text{Vert}(P) + \text{Vert}(Q)$



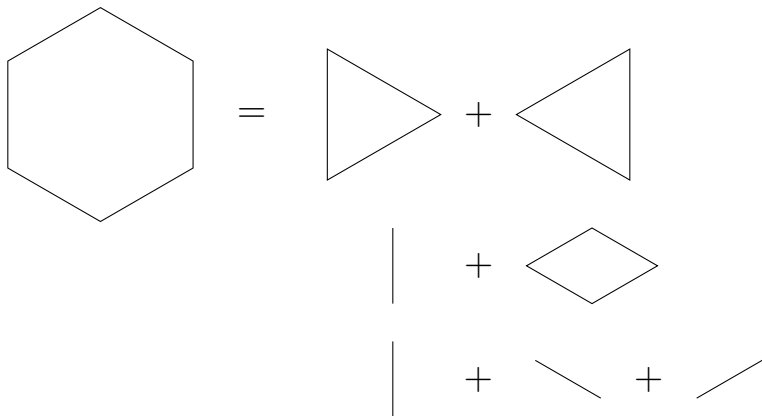
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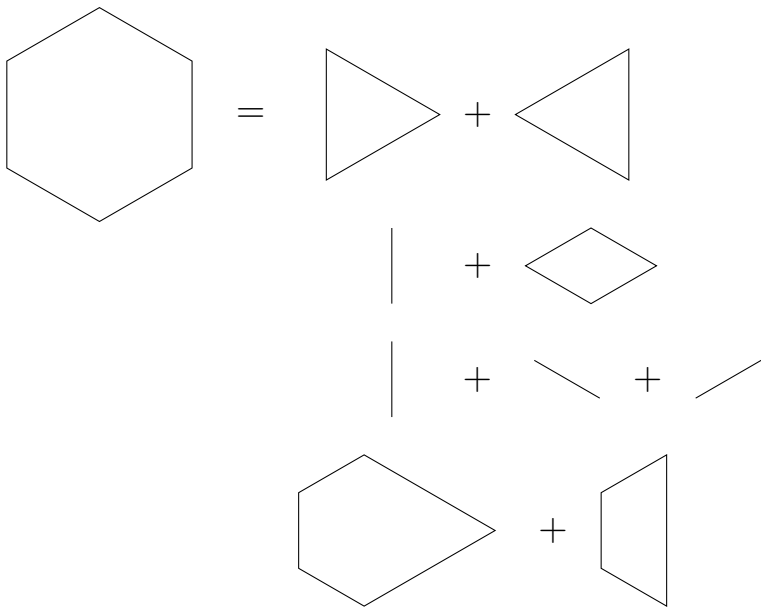
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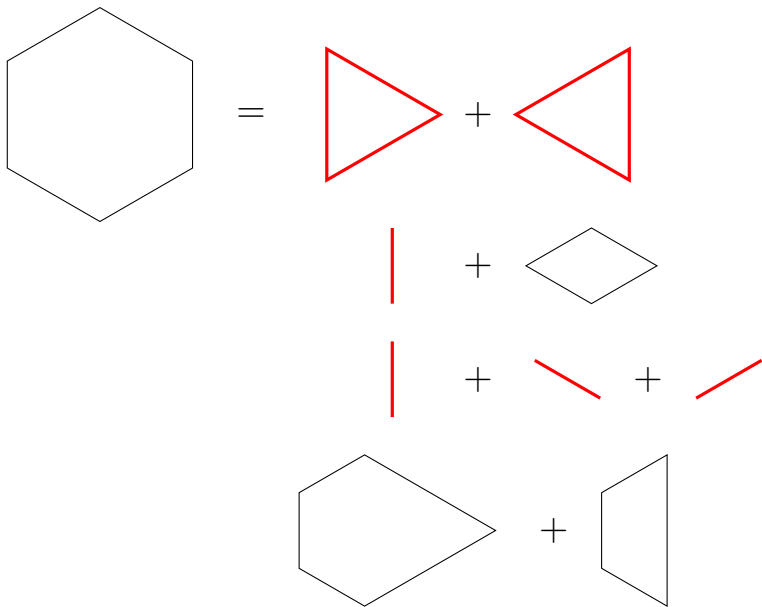
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$\Rightarrow$  What is the structure of  $\mathbb{DC}(P)$  ?

For indecomposable, see *Indecomposability and beyond via the graph of edge dependencies*, arXiv:2512.05307, with Arnau Padrol

# Minkowski summands



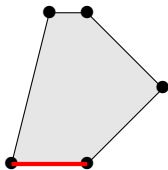
# Faces

## Definition

*Polytope:* convex hull of finitely many points in  $\mathbb{R}^n$   
bounded intersection of finitely many half-spaces in  $\mathbb{R}^n$

## Definition

*Face:*  $P^c := \{ \mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n ; \langle \mathbf{x}, \mathbf{c} \rangle = \max_{\mathbf{y} \in P} \langle \mathbf{y}, \mathbf{c} \rangle \}$



P

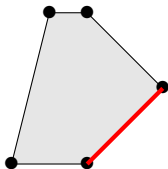
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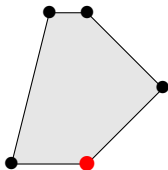
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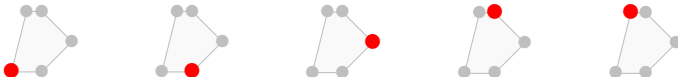


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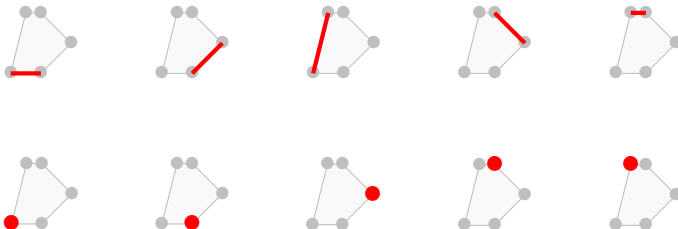
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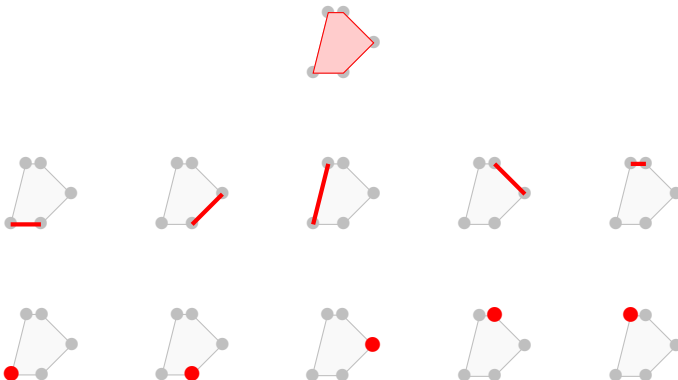
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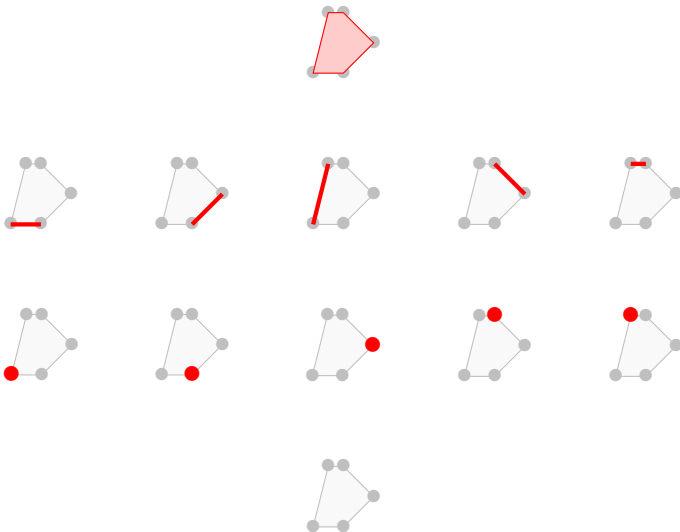
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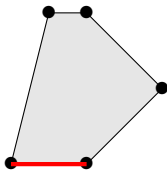


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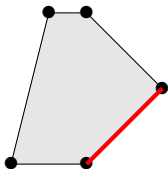
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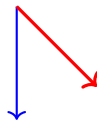
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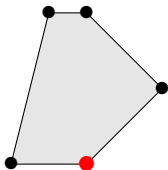


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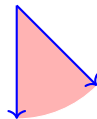
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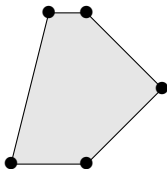
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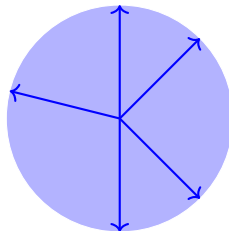
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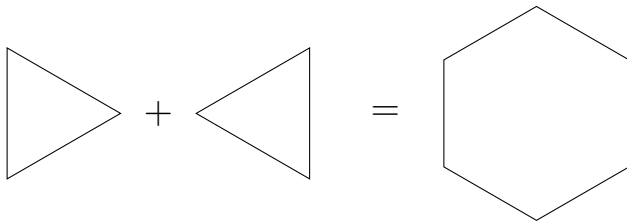
P



$\mathcal{N}_P$

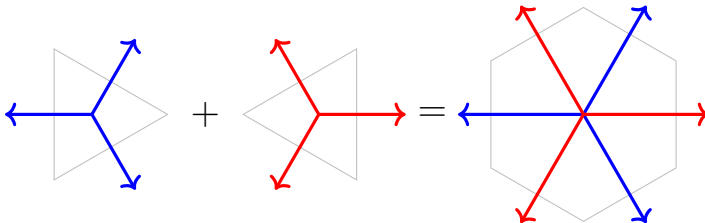
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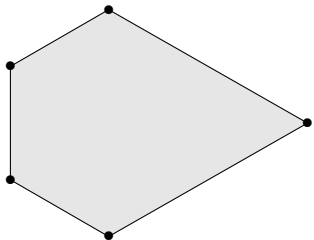
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$\mathcal{N}_P$ : Normal fan of polytope  $P$

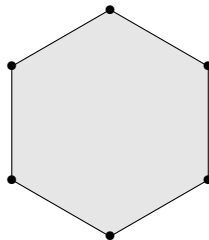
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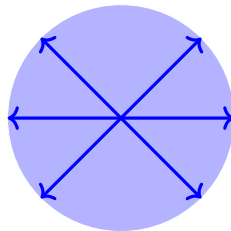
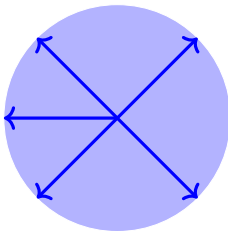
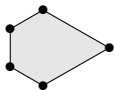
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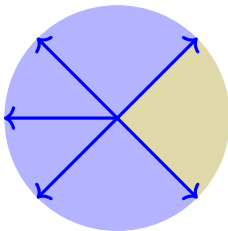
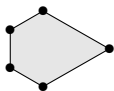
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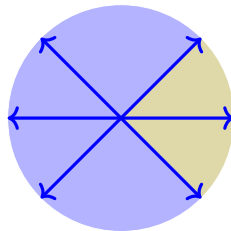
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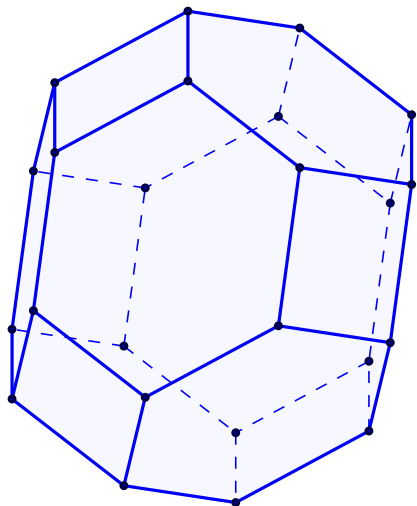
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coarsens



# Deformations of 3-dim permutahedron



Permutahedron  $\Pi_4$

Sequence of deformations of  $\Pi_4$

# Height deformation cone

## Theorem

$$Q \text{ deformation of } P \iff \mathcal{N}_Q \trianglelefteq \mathcal{N}_P$$

## Definition

*Height deformation cone:*  $\mathbb{DC}(P) = \{Q ; \mathcal{N}_Q \trianglelefteq \mathcal{N}_P\}$



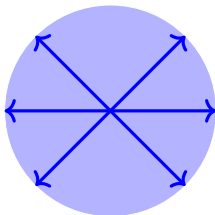
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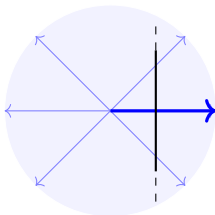
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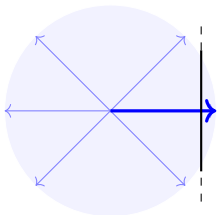
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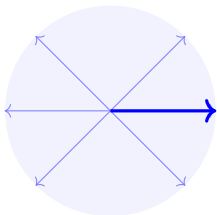
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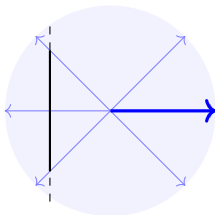
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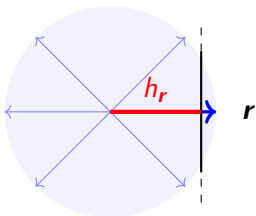
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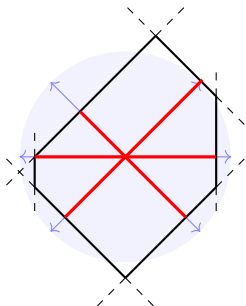
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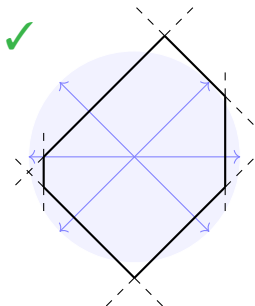
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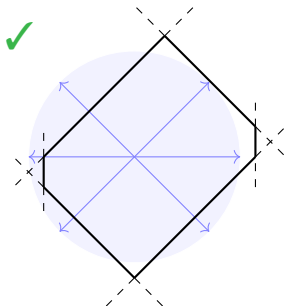
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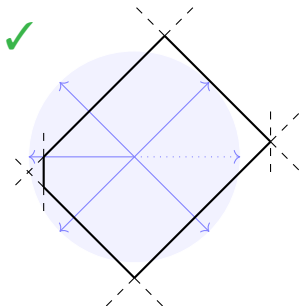
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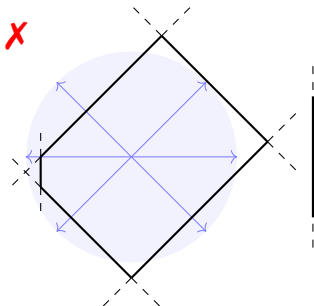
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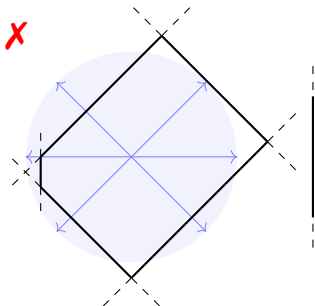
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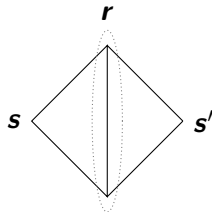
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$$P_{\mathbf{h}} = \{\mathbf{x} ; \langle \mathbf{x} | \mathbf{r} \rangle \leq h_r\}$$

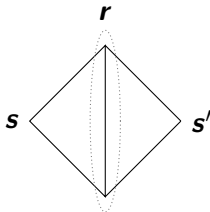
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then

$$\alpha_s h_s + \alpha_{s'} h_{s'} + \sum_r \alpha_r h_r \geq 0$$

# Edge-length deformation cone

## Theorem

$Q$  deformation of  $P \Leftrightarrow$  same edge-directions, but different lengths

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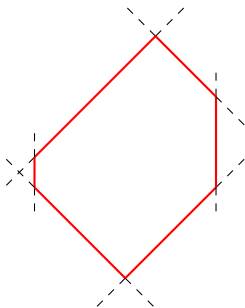
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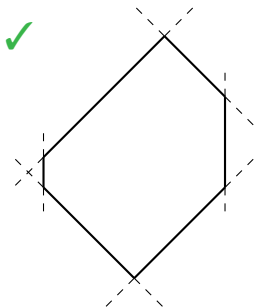
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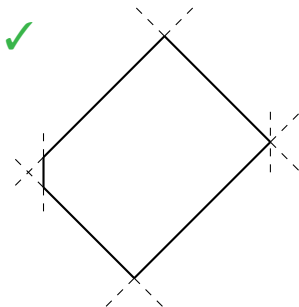
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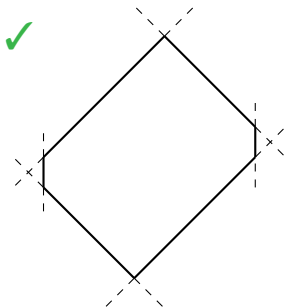
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## Theorem

$Q$  deformation of  $P \Leftrightarrow$  same edge-directions, but different lengths

## Definition

*Edge-length deformation cone:*  $\mathbb{DC}(P) = \{Q ; Q \text{ same edge-dir } P\}$



Parametrization:

*edge-length vector:*

$$\ell = (\ell_e)_{e \text{ edge}}$$

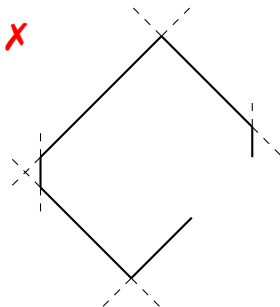
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*Polygonal face equations:*

**linear equations** on  $\ell$

$$\ell_e \geq 0 \text{ for all } e \text{ edge}$$

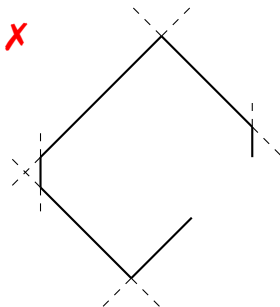
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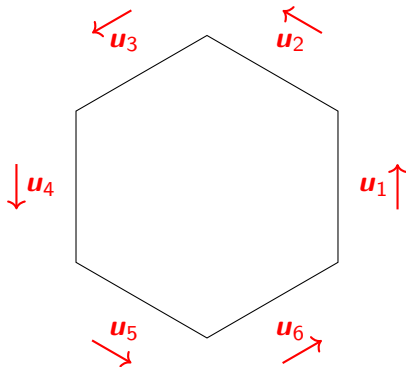
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**linear equations** on  $\ell$

$$\ell_e \geq 0 \text{ for all } e \text{ edge}$$

$P_\ell$  = start at a vertex, find the coordinates of the other vertices from the graph of  $P$  and  $\ell$

# Polygonal face equations



For  $F$  a 2-dim face of  $P$ :

$$\sum_e u_e = \mathbf{0} \quad , \quad u_e \text{ unit vector}$$

hence

$$\sum_e \ell_e u_e = \mathbf{0}$$

# Summary on $\mathbb{DC}(P)$

| $\mathbb{DC}(P)$     |                                                           |                                                                       |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| $Q$                  | $\ell$                                                    | $h$                                                                   |
| Minkowski summands   | edge-lengths                                              | heights on rays                                                       |
| $Q_1 + Q_2$          | $\ell_1 + \ell_2$                                         | $h_1 + h_2$                                                           |
| Dilation $\lambda Q$ | $\lambda \ell$                                            | $\lambda h$                                                           |
| Translations         | None                                                      | Lineal                                                                |
| <i>complicated</i>   | edge directions<br>Polygonal face eq.<br>$V$ -description | normal fan $\mathcal{N}_P$<br>Wall-crossing ineq.<br>$H$ -description |
| Polytope algebra     | Weight algebra                                            | Polynomial algebra                                                    |

$\mathbb{DC}(P)$  is a ray =  $P$  Minkowski indecomposable

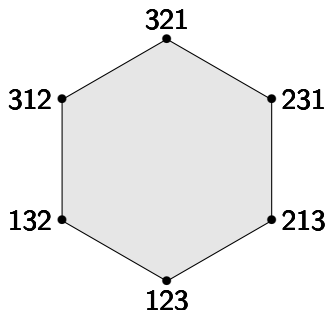
$\mathbb{DC}(P)$  is simplicial cone =  $P$  has **unique** Minkowski decomposition

*Deformed permutahedra = submodularity*



## Example (Permutahedron)

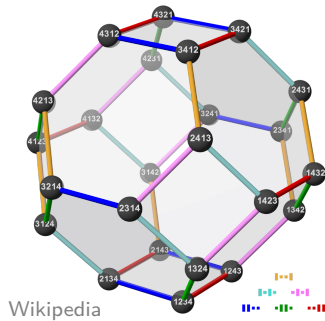
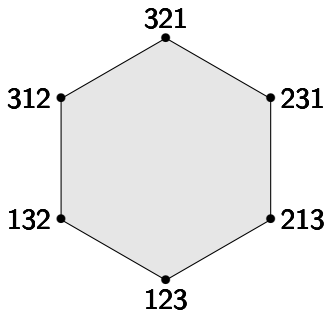
$$\Pi_n = \text{conv} \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} \sigma(1) \\ \vdots \\ \sigma(n) \end{pmatrix} ; \sigma \text{ permutation of } \{1, \dots, n\} \right\}$$



# Permutahedron

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Wikipedia

## Definition

*Braid fan*: arrangement of hyperplanes  $H_{i,j} := \{\mathbf{x} ; x_i = x_j\}$

# Braid fan

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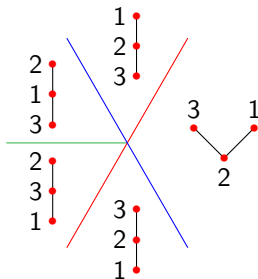
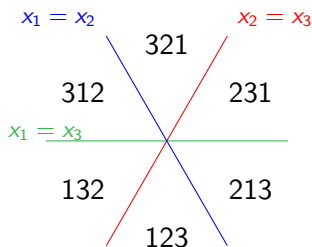
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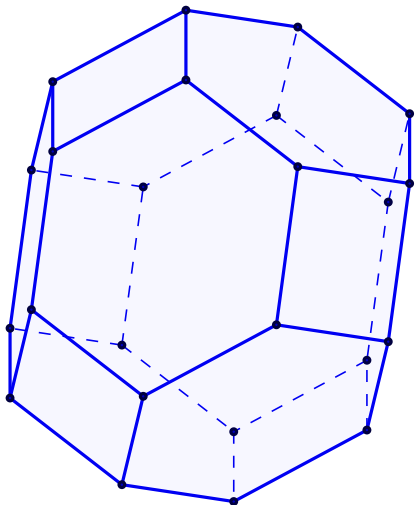
*Generalized permutahedron*: deformation of  $\Pi_n$

i.e.  $P$  generalized permutahedron iff  $\mathcal{N}_P$  coarsens braid fan

i.e.  $P$  generalized permutatahedron iff edges in directions  $\mathbf{e}_i - \mathbf{e}_j$



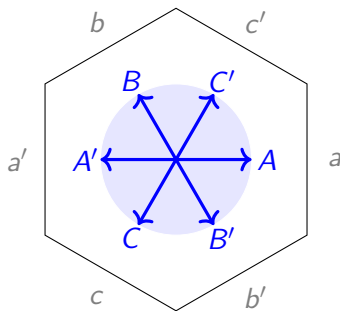
# Deformations of $\Pi_4$



Permutahedron  $\Pi_4$

Sequence of deformations of  $\Pi_4$

## 2-dimensional example



Wall-crossing inequalities:

$$h_A + h_B \geq h_{C'}$$

$$h_B + h_C \geq h_{A'}$$

$$h_C + h_A \geq h_{B'}$$

& 3 others ineq.

Polygonal face equations:

$$\ell_a - \ell_{a'} = \ell_b - \ell_{b'} = \ell_c - \ell_{c'}$$

$$\text{\& } \ell \in \mathbb{R}_+^6$$

## Definition

*Submodular functions*  $\mathbf{h} : 2^{[n]} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$

$$\forall A, B \subseteq [n], \quad h(A) + h(B) \geq h(A \cap B) + h(A \cup B)$$

In bijection with generalized permutahedra:

$$P_{\mathbf{h}} = \left\{ \mathbf{x} ; \sum_{i \in A} x_i \leq h(A) \text{ for all } A \subseteq [n] \text{ and } \sum_{i=1}^n x_i = h([n]) \right\}$$

## *Submodular Cone in general*

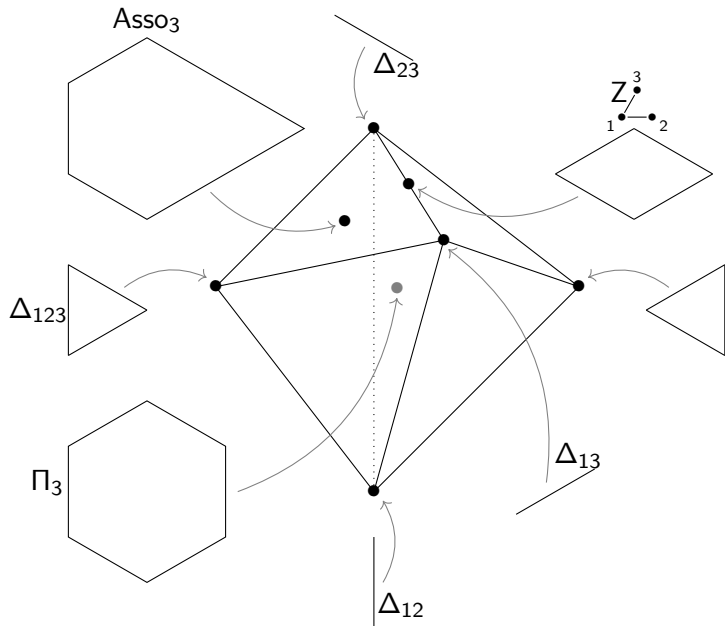


## Definition

*Submodular cone*: deformation cone of the permutahedron  $\Pi_n$

|                 | $\mathbb{SC}_n$        |
|-----------------|------------------------|
| Dim (no lineal) | $2^n - n - 1$          |
| # facets        | $\binom{n}{2} 2^{n-2}$ |
| # rays          | unknown!               |

# Submodular Cone for $\Pi_3$



## Definition

*Submodular cone*  $\mathbb{SC}_n$ : deformation cone of the permutahedron  $\Pi_n$

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|-----------------|------------------------|
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# Submodular Cone's faces

## Definition

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*If  $Q$  deformation of  $P$ , then  $\mathbb{DC}(Q)$  is a face of  $\mathbb{DC}(P)$ .*

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|                 | $\mathbb{SC}_n$        | $\mathbb{DC}(\text{Asso}_n)$ |
|-----------------|------------------------|------------------------------|
| Dim (no lineal) | $2^n - n - 1$          | $\binom{n}{2}$               |
| # facets        | $\binom{n}{2} 2^{n-2}$ | $\binom{n}{2}$               |
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|                 | $\mathbb{SC}_n$        | $\mathbb{DC}(\text{Asso}_n)$  | Graph zono. | Nestohedra |
|-----------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------|------------|
| Dim (no lineal) | $2^n - n - 1$          | $\binom{n}{2}$                | ✓           | ✓          |
| # facets        | $\binom{n}{2} 2^{n-2}$ | $\binom{n}{2}$                | ✓           | ✓          |
| # rays          | unknown!               | $\binom{n}{2}$<br>simplicial! | ✗           | ✗          |

But that belongs to a different presentation...

Recall:  $\dim = 11$ ,  $\text{nbr facets} = 80$

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Draw all generalized permutahedra ? (ask computer)



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22 107 faces

(Please do not draw...)

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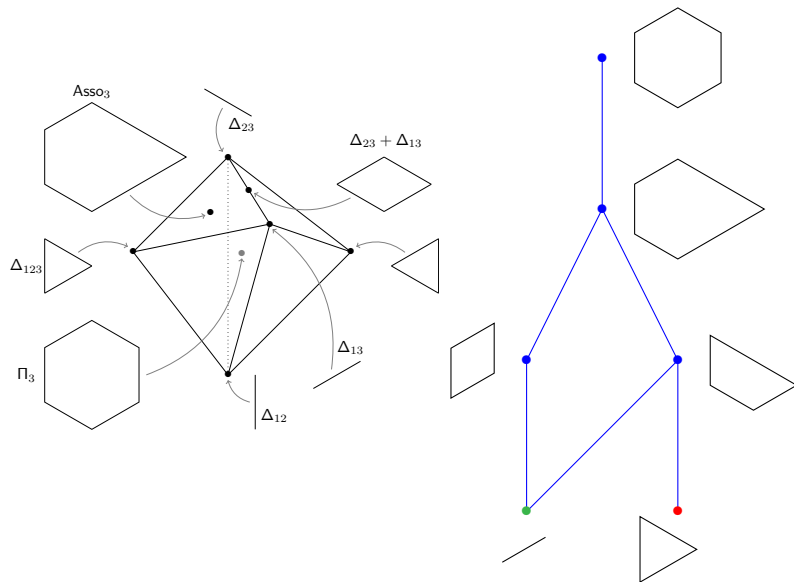
22 107 faces

(Please do not draw...)

$\implies$  quotient by symmetries

# Symmetries of the braid fan

*Braid symmetries:* permutation of coordinates + central symmetry



Recall:  $\dim = 11$ ,  $\text{nbr facets} = 80$

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22 107 faces

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Recall:  $\dim = 11$ ,  $\text{nbr facets} = 80$

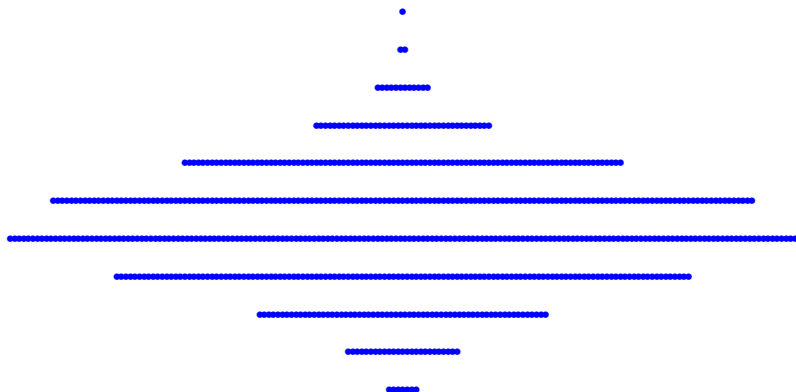
Draw all generalized permutahedra ? (ask computer)

22 107 faces

$\implies$  quotient by symmetries

703 “faces”

# Reduced face lattice of $\mathbb{SC}_4$



|       |   |    |    |     |     |     |    |    |    |    |    |       |
|-------|---|----|----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|----|----|----|-------|
| $d$   | 1 | 2  | 3  | 4   | 5   | 6   | 7  | 8  | 9  | 10 | 11 | total |
| $f_d$ | 7 | 25 | 64 | 127 | 174 | 155 | 97 | 39 | 12 | 2  | 1  | 703   |

# Reduced $f$ -vector of $\mathbb{SC}_n$

Reduced  $\mathbb{SC}_n$   $f$ -vector:

$$n = 3$$

$$\dim \mathbb{SC}_3 = 4$$

$$(2, 2, 1, 1)$$

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$$\dim \mathbb{SC}_4 = 11$$

$$(7, 25, 64, 127, 174, \\ 155, 97, 39, 12, 2, 1)$$

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*Thanks to Winfried Bruns for  
helping compute!*

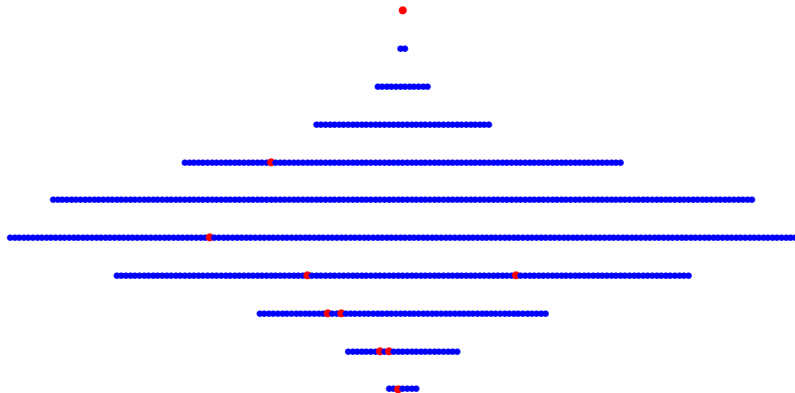
Database for  $\dim$  1-4 & 19-26

$$n = 5, \dim \mathbb{SC}_5 = 26$$

\*672  
\*24 026  
\*373 433  
\*3 355 348  
19 739 627  
81 728 494  
249 483 675  
579 755 845  
1 048 953 035  
1 501 555 944  
1 719 688 853  
1 587 510 812  
1 186 372 740  
719 012 097  
353 190 577  
140 265 886  
44 831 594  
11 464 559  
\*2 326 596  
\*372 031  
\*46 330  
\*4 572  
\*355  
\*30  
\*2  
\*1

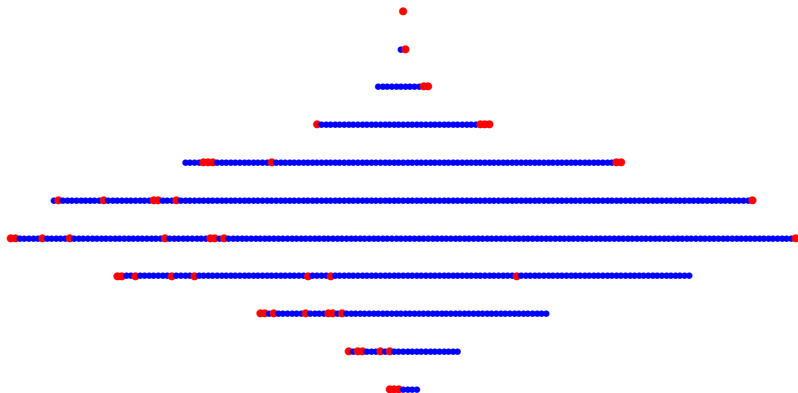


# Graphical zonotopes & Nestohedra are sparse



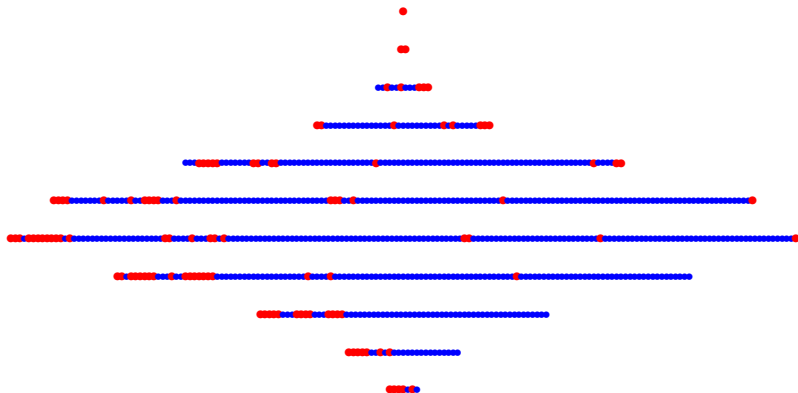
With: Graphical Zonotopes  
10 polytopes

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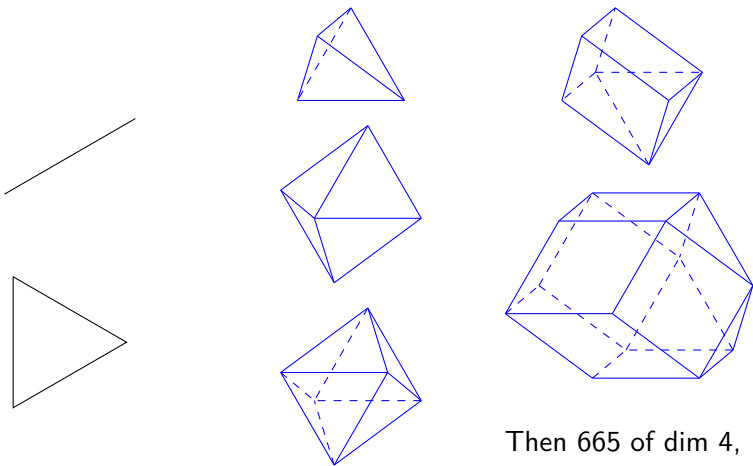
With: Graphical Zonotopes & Nestohedra  
10 + 46 polytopes

# Everything is quite negligible...



With: Graphical Zono & Nestohedra  $\subsetneq$  Hypergraphic Polytopes,  
+ Shard Polytopes, Quotientopes,  
+ Matroid Polytopes  
= 112 polytope (only...)

# What about the rays of $\mathbb{SC}_4$ ?



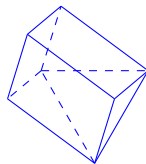
Then 665 of dim 4,  
> 126 629 of dim 6

# Strawberry & Persimmon

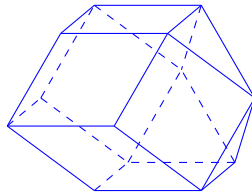
Deformed permutahedra:

Minkowski indecomposable ✓

Matroid Polytopes ✗



*Strawberry*



*Persimmon*

# Strawberry & Persimmon

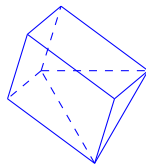
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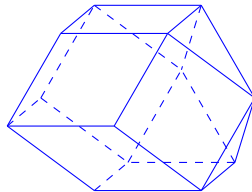
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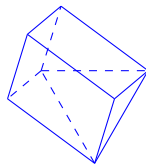
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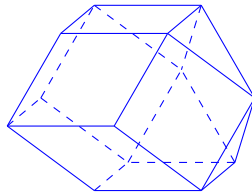
*Persimmon*:

Polypositroid ✗

Removahedron ✗



*Strawberry*



*Persimmon*

Theorem ((approximately) Nguyen, '86)

*The number  $t_n$  of rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$  satisfies*

$$2^{2^n \cdot n^{-3/2}} \leq t_n$$



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**N.B.:** By Upper Bound Theorem:  $t_n \leq n^{2^n}$ .

Precisely:  $n - 2 \leq \log_2 \log_2 t_n \leq n + \log_2 \log_2 n + 1$

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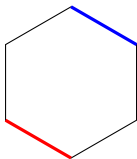
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Let's do an induction!

*Inductive construction of (rays of)  $\mathbb{SC}_n$*

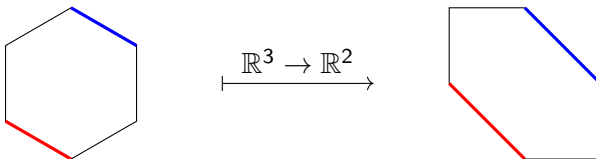
$P^+$ ,  $P^-$ : **opposite** faces, maximizing/minimizing  $e_{n+1}$  on  $P$ .





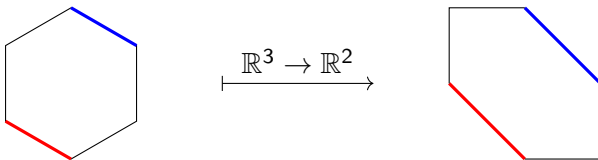
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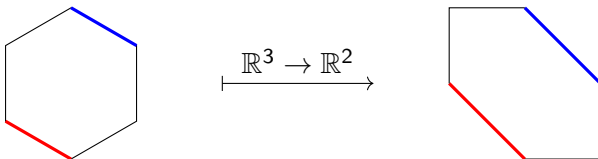
*Deformed permutahedra are **uniquely** determined by their pair of top and bottom faces.*

*Thus,  $P \mapsto (P^+, P^-)$  is a bijection:*

What's the reciprocal bijection?

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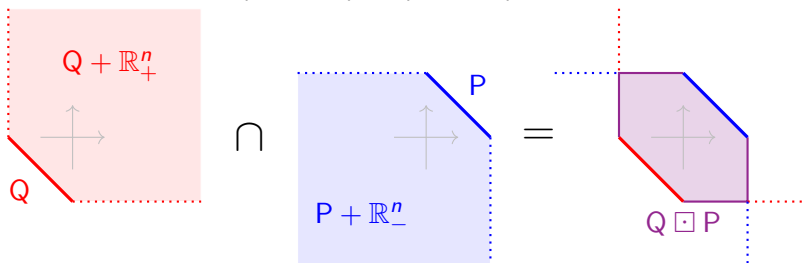
*Thus,  $P \mapsto (P^+, P^-)$  is a bijection:  $\mathbb{SC}_{n+1} \simeq$  (roughly  $\mathbb{SC}_n^2$ )*

What's the reciprocal bijection?

## Theorem (Frank '11)

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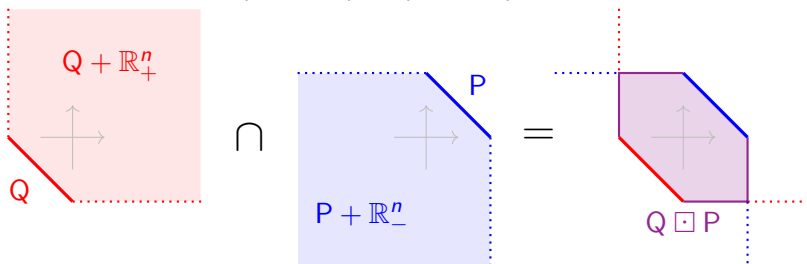
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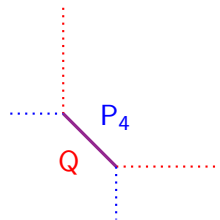
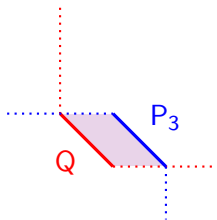
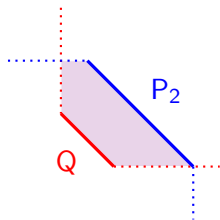
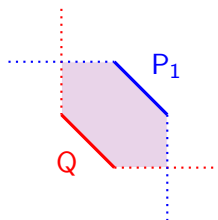
*projection* of  $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^{n+1}$  is  $\downarrow(\mathbf{x}) := (x_1, \dots, x_n)$

*lift* of  $\mathbf{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$  is  $\uparrow(\mathbf{x}) := (x_1, \dots, x_n, -\sum_{i=1}^n x_i)$

Reciprocal of  $P \mapsto (\downarrow(P^+), \downarrow(P^-))$  is the map  $(P, Q) \mapsto \uparrow(Q \boxplus P)$

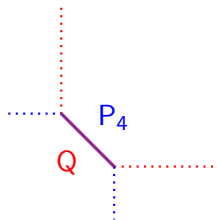
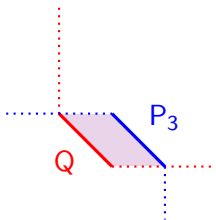
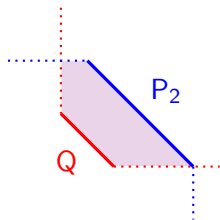
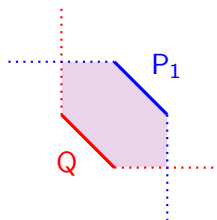
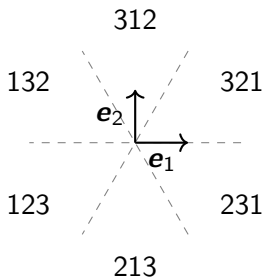
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## Theorem (Frank '11, rewritten)

There is a bijection between  $\mathbb{SC}_{n+1}$  and pairs  $(P, Q) \in \mathbb{SC}_n^2$  with  $\forall i, \sigma, P_i^\sigma \leq Q_i^\sigma$ . Namely:

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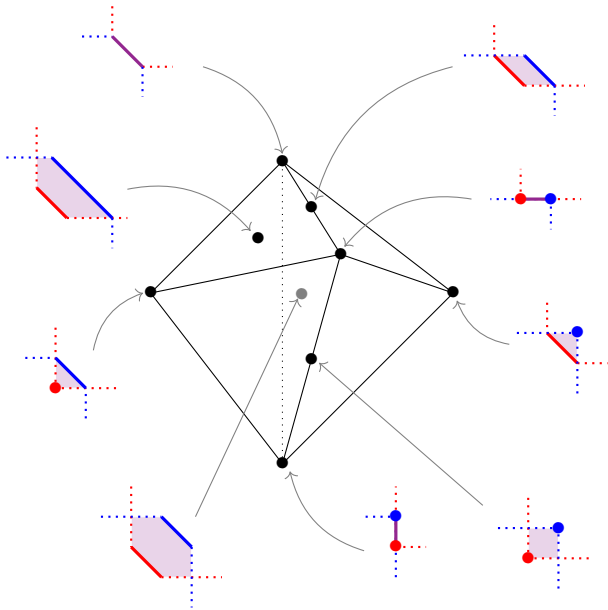
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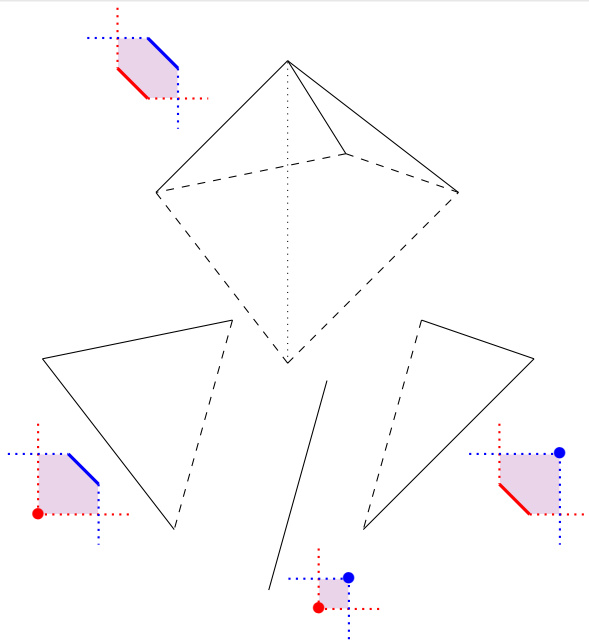
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**Problem:** inductive process on  $\mathbb{SC}_n$ , not on the face lattice of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$

# Not inductive process on face lattice of $\mathcal{SC}_n$



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**Problem:**  $P$  and  $Q$  rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_n \not\Rightarrow \uparrow(Q \square P)$  rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_{n+1}$

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$P, Q$  rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$  + *small condition*

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**Lemma**

If  $(S, P)$  is fertile, then  $(\uparrow(S \boxplus R), \uparrow(Q \boxplus P))$  is also fertile.

**Good news:** Fertility is hereditary!



## Lemma (Consequently)

*If  $\{P_1, P_2, \dots, P_r\}$  are rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$  with  $(P_i, P_j)$  fertile for all  $i, j$ , then there exist  $\lambda_{i,j} > 0$ ,  $\mathbf{t}_{i,j} \in \mathbb{R}^n$  such that  $\left\{ \uparrow((\lambda_{i,j}P_j + \mathbf{t}_{i,j}) \boxdot P_i) ; 1 \leq i, j \leq r \right\}$  are rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_{n+1}$  also pairwise fertile.*

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I can construct 1 rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_{n+1}$  for each fertile pair of rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$   
+ fertility is conserved

$\Rightarrow$  I construct  $\rho^{2^{n-k}}$  rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$ , with  $\rho = \#(\text{fertile family of } \mathbb{SC}_k)$

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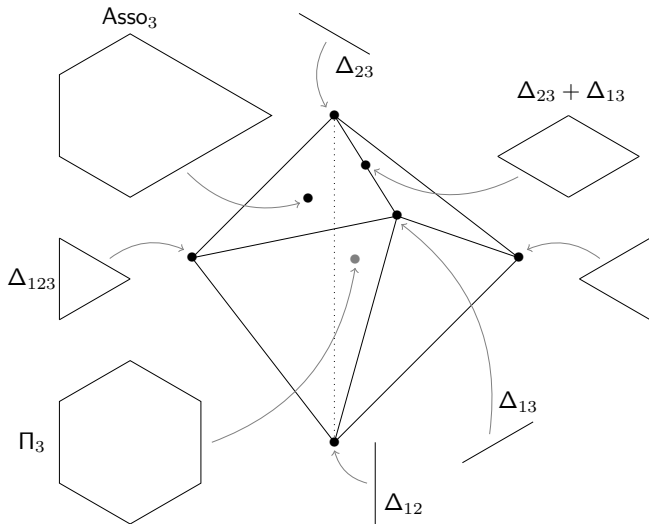
*For  $n \geq 5$ , the number of rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$  is bigger than*

$$656^{2^{n-5}}$$

With this induction on (the face lattice of)  $\mathbb{SC}_n$ :

- Lower bound on the  $f$ -vector of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$
- Lower bound on the number of non-simplicial faces of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$
- New partition of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$
- ...

# Thank you!

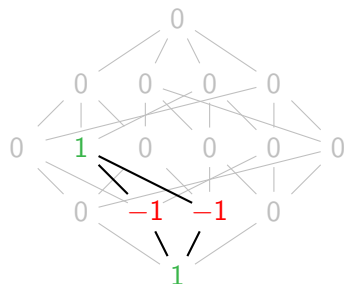
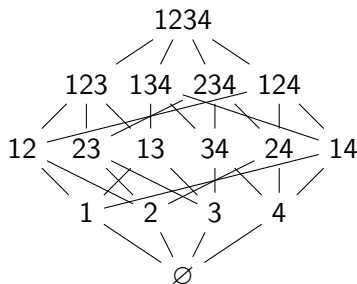


# Tools: submodular dependencies

Notations:  $Sx = S \cup \{x\}$ ,  $(\mathbf{f}_x)_{x \subseteq [n]}$  canonical basis of  $\mathbb{R}^{2^{[n]}}$

## Definition

*Submodular vector*  $\mathbf{n}(S, u, v) = \mathbf{f}_{Suv} - \mathbf{f}_{Su} - \mathbf{f}_{Sv} + \mathbf{f}_S$   
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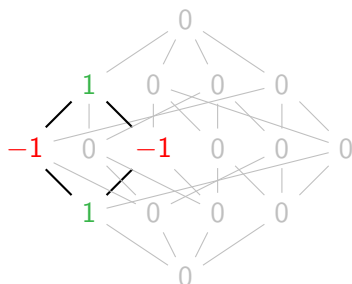
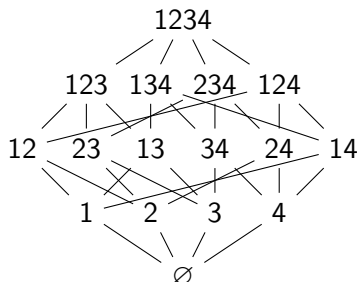


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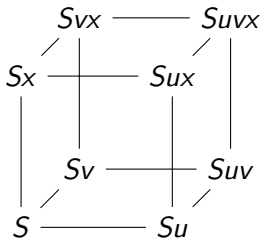
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## Lemma (Cubic relation)

$u, v, x \notin S \subseteq [n]$

$$\mathbf{n}(Suvx, u, v) + \mathbf{n}(Sux, u, x) = \mathbf{n}(Suv, u, v) + \mathbf{n}(Suvx, u, x)$$



**NB:** Cubic relations generates all relations of submodular vectors



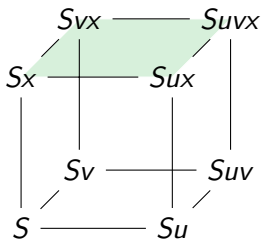
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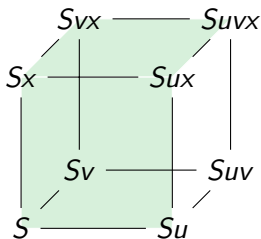
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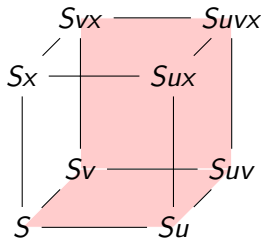
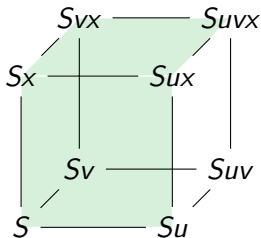
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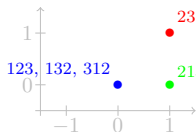
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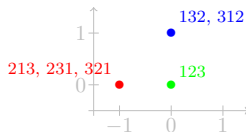
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# Fertility

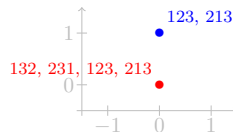
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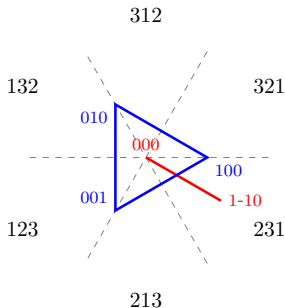
$i = 1$



$i = 2$



$i = 3$



## Multiple choice questions (sometimes several answer possible)

| A sum of 2 co-planar triangles can have                           | 3 edges                          | 4 edges                                 | 5 edges                                 | 6 edges                                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| $\mathcal{N}_{P+Q} = \text{--- of } \mathcal{N}_P, \mathcal{N}_Q$ | union                            | intersection                            | common refinement                       | product                                   |
| Edge directions of $\text{GP} \in$                                | $\{\mathbf{e}_i\}_i$             | $\{\mathbf{e}_i + \mathbf{e}_j\}_{i,j}$ | $\{\mathbf{e}_i - \mathbf{e}_j\}_{i,j}$ | $\{\mathbf{e}_i \pm \mathbf{e}_j\}_{i,j}$ |
| $Z_G$ has no hexagonal face iff $G$ is                            | a tree                           | $K_3$ -free                             | $K_4$ -free                             | complete                                  |
| --- form a basis of $\text{Vect}(\mathbb{SC}_n)$                  | $\{\Delta_X\}_{X \subseteq [n]}$ | nestohedra                              | shard polytopes                         | matroid polytopes                         |
| $\dim \mathbb{SC}_3 =$                                            | 3                                | 4                                       | 5                                       | 11                                        |
| Group of symmetries of $\mathbb{SC}_n$ :                          | $\text{Free}_n$                  | $\mathcal{S}_n$                         | $\mathcal{S}_n \times \mathbb{Z}_2$     | $\mathcal{S}_n \times \mathbb{Z}_n$       |
| # 3-dim indecomposable GP:                                        | 3                                | 5                                       | 7                                       | 37                                        |

1. Show that  $\text{Vert}(P + Q) \subseteq \{\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v} ; \mathbf{u} \in \text{Vert}(P), \mathbf{v} \in \text{Vert}(Q)\}$ . Find an example with strict inclusion. Prove that  $\mathcal{N}_{P+Q}$  is the common refinement of  $\mathcal{N}_P$  and  $\mathcal{N}_Q$ .
2. Find all the ways to write the 2-dimensional permutahedron as a Minkowski sum of indecomposable polytopes.
3. Prove that  $\mathbf{h}_{P+Q} = \mathbf{h}_P + \mathbf{h}_Q$  and  $\ell_{P+Q} = \ell_P + \ell_Q$ . What are  $\mathbf{h}_{P+t}$  and  $\ell_{P+t}$ ?
4. Prove that a triangle is Minkowski indecomposable. Deduce that all simplicial polytopes are Minkowski indecomposable.

5. Take vectors  $\mathbf{s}, \mathbf{s}', \mathbf{r}_1, \dots, \mathbf{r}_{d-1}$  such that  $C = \text{cone}(\mathbf{s}, \mathbf{r}_1, \dots, \mathbf{r}_{d-1})$  and  $C' = \text{cone}(\mathbf{s}', \mathbf{r}_1, \dots, \mathbf{r}_{d-1})$  are simplicial cones which intersect on their proper face  $C \cap C' = \text{cone}(\mathbf{r}_1, \dots, \mathbf{r}_{d-1})$ . Show that there exist  $\alpha_{\mathbf{s}}, \alpha_{\mathbf{s}'} > 0$  and  $\alpha_{\mathbf{r}_i} \in \mathbb{R}$  such that:

$$\alpha_{\mathbf{s}}\mathbf{s} + \alpha_{\mathbf{s}'}\mathbf{s}' + \sum_i \alpha_{\mathbf{r}_i}\mathbf{r}_i = \mathbf{0}$$

6. Compute (and draw) the deformation cone of a parallelogram (use the edge-lengths point of view). What about a parallelepiped? Show that there is a **unique** way to write a parallelepiped  $P$  as a sum of Minkowski indecomposable polytopes.

7. Show that  $\mathbb{SC}_n$  has  $\binom{n}{2}2^{n-2}$  facets. Give bounds on its number of rays.

8. Show that graphical zonotopes are generalized permutahedra. Show that nestohedra are generalized permutahedra. Show that matroid polytopes are generalized permutahedra. Which are indecomposable?

9. If  $G$  is triangle-free, then  $\mathbb{DC}(Z_G)$  is simplicial (see lecture). Each face of  $\mathbb{DC}(Z_G)$  is associated to a polytope: which polytope?

10. The *weighted graphical zonotope* of a graph  $G = (V, E)$  and weight (on edges)  $\omega : E \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_+^*$  is  $Z_{G,\omega} := \sum_{(i,j) \in E} \omega(i,j)[\mathbf{e}_i, \mathbf{e}_j]$ . Show that:  $\{\text{zonotopes}\} \cap \{\text{generalized permutahedra}\} = \{\text{weighted graphical zonotopes}\}$ . Show that the cone of weighted graphical zonotopes is a section (i.e. intersection with a linear sub-space) of the submodular cone, such that the rays of this section are rays of  $\mathbb{SC}_n$ . What is the dimension of this section?

11. Prove the cubic relations hold. Show that cubic relations generates all linear relations between submodular vectors.